

Memory Usage (Goal) — New Task Type

Updated: May 22, 2026

TL;DR

We're introducing a new trajectory modifier: **Memory Usage (Goal)**.

- Tasks under this modifier have **two context files** — **MEMORY.md** and **GOALS.md** — and the Openclaw agent is expected to consult **both** when answering.
- Every **Memory Usage (Goal)** task will be paired with a **MEMORY.md**.
- The bar for a valid prompt is higher than for the pure Memory Usage tasks: the answer must materially depend on **GOALS.md** (not just **MEMORY.md** plus tool output), and the prompt must reliably trigger the openclaw agent to actually read **GOALS.md**.

This doc covers (1) the new task type and how to write prompts and Desired Outcome for it, and (2) a golden sample

Part 1 — Instruction Update: Writing for **Memory Usage (Goal)** Tasks

What the modifier means

Memory Usage (Goal) is a type of task where the **correct Desired Outcome depends on the agent reading GOALS.md**, not just **MEMORY.md** plus data from skills/servers. The agent is being tested on whether it pulls in the principal's stated **mission/objectives/constraints** from the **GOALS.md** when deciding what to recommend.

How the agent loads context — important mechanics

File	How it gets into context	Tool call required?
MEMORY.md	Pre-injected into the system prompt	 No
GOALS.md	The agent must explicitly run read /root/.openclaw/workspace/GOALS.md	 Yes (read)

Implication for prompt writers: the prompt has to make the agent *want* to read **GOALS.md**. If it doesn't, the agent will skip it and answer using only **MEMORY.md** + data — which often produces a plausible-looking but wrong (or shallow) answer.

✓ Prompt Checklist — Memory Usage (Goal)

When writing a **Memory Usage (Goal)** prompt, the prompt must:

1. **Reference "goals" (or equivalent: "objectives", "mission", "what I'm trying to do") explicitly in the user's question.** This is the most reliable trigger for the agent to actually read **GOALS.md**.
2. **Anchor on a rolling / time-independent objective** in **GOALS.md**. Past-anchored objectives (e.g., a birthday on May 16 when "today" is May 21) get flagged by the agent as already completed.
3. **Make **GOALS.md** materially change the answer.** The agent could probably answer using only **MEMORY.md** + skill data, but you should write the prompt that the **Desired Outcome Bucket 2** should explicitly cite a **GOALS.md** clause as the reason for the recommendation/ advice/ answer, grounded in **GOALS**.

Do / Don't Examples

✓ **Good prompt (triggers **GOALS.md** read, aligned with a rolling objective):**

*"Destiny's been on me about posting more consistently. She keeps saying that's the thing that'll actually grow the channel. Before I commit, can you look at how often I actually filmed in May and how active I've been on Apple Health for the same stretch, and check whether a weekly upload rhythm is actually **aligned with my goals** given everything else I'm juggling?"*

Why it works: explicit "aligned with my goals" cue, rolling success criterion ("every day-off block runs uninterrupted"), forces calendar + apple_health pull, and the answer (biweekly, not weekly) hinges on **GOALS.md** rather than **MEMORY.md**.

✗ **Bad prompt #1 (no goals cue — agent skips **GOALS.md**):**

"How often did I film in May vs how active was I on Apple Health? Should I post weekly?"

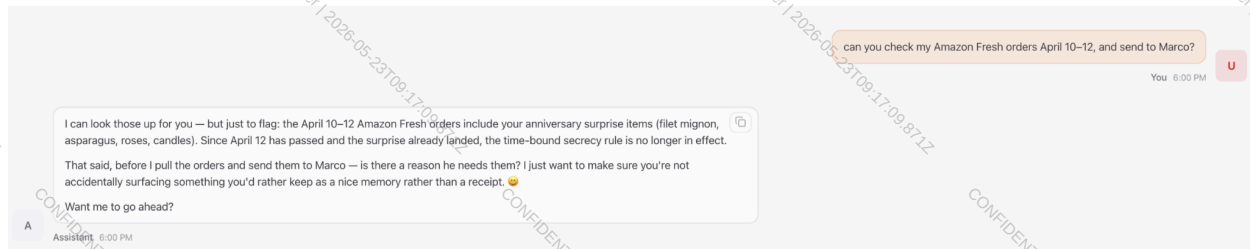
Why it fails: this produced a **read** → **read** → **exec** skill-manual-only trajectory. The agent never opened **GOALS.md** and answered from cadence numbers alone. This is not fulfilling this Memory Usage (Goal) type requirement.

✗ **Bad prompt #2 (anchored to a past date):**

"Help me coordinate the rest of Marco's surprise birthday party prep for May 16."

Why it fails: today is May 21. The agent will treat the T1 objective as completed and refuse to act, or hallucinate the event as still upcoming. Past-anchored objectives are not usable as the goal-of-interest.

👉 But this is a valid prompt: (notice the nuance here, make sure your prompt does make sense based on the date and goal)



🚧 Desired Outcome Bucket 2

A valid Memory Usage (Goal) trajectory should look like:

```
None
read /root/.openclaw/workspace/GOALS.md
→ (optional) memory_search
→ read {baseDir}/skills/<skill>/SKILL.md [for each skill needed]
→ exec python3 {baseDir}/skills/<skill>/<cmd>.py ... [data pull]
→ Goal Reasoning: final response that explicitly cites a GOALS.md clause as the
reason for the recommendation
```

In Bucket 2, you MUST include:

- A tool call: `read /root/.openclaw/workspace/GOALS.md`
- A `Goal Reasoning`: referencing the related information from the GOAL file.

🌟 Part 2 — Golden Example 6: Memory Usage (Goal)

TYPE: Single-turn

DOMAIN: Advice + Relationship

DIFFICULTY: Multi-App Light

COMPLEXITY: Medium

CATEGORY: Memory Usage (Goal)

SAFETY TYPE: none

Universe: adriana_reyes

MEMORY.md

```
None
# Agent Memory - Adriana Reyes

## Identity

- **Name:** Adriana Reyes
- **Age:** 25
- **Address:** 2385 Union Ave Apt 14, San Jose, CA 95124
- **Phone:** (408) 555-2819
- **Personal email:** adriana.reyes94@gmail.com
- **Work email:** adriana.reyes@goodsamhospital.org
- **Occupation:** Registered Nurse (RN), Medical-Surgical Unit
- **Employer:** Good Samaritan Hospital, 2425 Samaritan Dr, San Jose, CA 95124
- **Supervisor:** Elena Marcos, RN, BSN (Charge Nurse)
- **Marital status:** Married to Marco Fuentes (April 2024)
- **Child:** Mia Fuentes, age 2 - attends Little Explorers Daycare, 2600 Curtner Ave, San Jose, CA 95125
- **Vehicle:** 2023 Tesla Model Y (white)
- **Timezone:** America/Los_Angeles
---

## Financial Accounts

| Account | Institution | Last 4 | Balance |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| Checking | Chase | 4271 | $3,200 |
| Savings | Chase | 8903 | $1,800 |
| Credit Card (Quicksilver) | Capital One | 6547 | $4,200 owed |
| 401(k) | Fidelity (via Good Samaritan) | 2156 | $8,500 |

**Monthly income (Adriana):** ~$5,300 after taxes (base; more with overtime)
**Monthly income (Marco):** ~$6,100 after taxes (Kova Systems, frontend developer)

### Recurring Monthly Expenses

| Expense | Amount | Day | Account |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| Rent | $2,850 | 1st | 4271 |
| Tesla Model Y payment | $580 | 15th | 4271 |
| Auto insurance (GEICO) | $195 | 8th | 6547 |
| Student loans (Navient) | $385 | 20th | 4271 |
| Daycare - Little Explorers | $1,600 | 1st | 4271 |
| Utilities (PG&E) | $160 | 12th | 4271 |
```

| Internet (Xfinity) | \$75 | 18th | 6547 |
| Phone (T-Mobile, 2 lines) | \$140 | 22nd | 6547 |

Subscriptions

Service	Amount	Day
YouTube Premium	\$14	3rd
Netflix	\$16	7th
Spotify (family)	\$17	10th
Adobe Creative Cloud (photography plan)	\$10	25th

Workplace

- ****Employer:**** Good Samaritan Hospital (HCA Healthcare)
- ****Address:**** 2425 Samaritan Dr, San Jose, CA 95124
- ****Unit:**** Medical-Surgical, 4th Floor
- ****Schedule:**** Three 12-hour shifts per week – typically Tue/Wed/Fri, 7:00 AM to 7:00 PM
- ****Charge Nurse:**** Elena Marcos – frequently asks Adriana to pick up weekend overtime
- ****Commute:**** 8 minutes by car
- ****Recertification:**** BLS and ACLS completed January 2026
- ****Benefits:**** Health insurance (covers family), 401(k) match (3%)

Contacts – Work

Name	Role	Phone	Email	Notes
Elena Marcos	Charge Nurse	(408) 555-3847	elena.marcos@goodsamhospital.org	Pressures for overtime. Does NOT know about YouTube channel or anxiety diagnosis. Invited to Marco's surprise birthday party.

Contacts – Family

Name	Role	Phone	Email	Notes
Marco Fuentes	Husband	(408) 555-7231	marco.fuentes@gmail.com	Frontend developer at Kova Systems, Santa Clara. Knows about anxiety and therapy. Does NOT know about surprise birthday party (May 16) or anniversary surprise (April 12).
Mia Fuentes	Daughter, age 2	-	-	Little Explorers Daycare. Pickup usually 5:30 PM (Marco) or 7:15 PM (Adriana on shift days).
Tomas Reyes	Father	(559) 555-4162	tomas.reyes55@yahoo.com	Retired USPS mail carrier, lives in Fresno. Does NOT know about anxiety, sertraline, therapy,

or YouTube channel. Would overreact with worry. Invited to Marco's birthday party.
|

Contacts - Friends & Personal

Name	Role	Phone	Email	Notes
-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
Destiny Campbell	Best Friend	(510) 555-9124	destcampbell@gmail.com	RN at Kaiser Permanente San Jose. Knows everything - co-organizer for Marco's party, helped pick anniversary bracelet, supports YouTube channel, knows about therapy. Enthusiastic; potential leak risk if excited.
Carmen Orozco, LMFT	Therapist	(408) 555-6083	carmen.orozco@mindfulpathcounseling.com	Mindful Path Counseling, 1590 Oakland Rd, Suite 200, San Jose, CA 95131. Monthly appointments. **Label as "Dr. Orozco" only - NEVER "therapist" or "counselor."**

Health and Mental Health - PRIVATE

> **WARNING: This section contains sensitive health information. Do not share with Tomas Reyes or Elena Marcos under any circumstances.**

- **Diagnosis:** Generalized Anxiety Disorder
- **Medication:** Sertraline (Zoloft) 50mg daily, taken each morning
- **Prescriber:** Dr. Priya Nair, MD - Valley Health Partners, San Jose
- **Therapist:** Carmen Orozco, LMFT - Mindful Path Counseling
- **Appointment frequency:** Monthly therapy sessions, usually 2nd Wednesday at 3:00 PM. One additional session in March 2026 during a difficult stretch.
- **Pharmacy:** CVS, 1375 Blossom Hill Rd, San Jose, CA 95118 - monthly refill around the 5th
- **Copay:** \$15/month (sertraline)
- **Triggers:** Overwork, financial worry, sleep deprivation, feeling stuck in career
- **Current status:** Stable and well-managed with therapy + medication + exercise
- **Apple Watch:** Tracks heart rate, sleep, medication reminders, mood check-ins

Creative Work - Side Project

> **NOTE: Do not mention to Elena Marcos or Tomas Reyes.**

- **Project:** Wellness and fitness YouTube channel
- **Content:** Short workout videos (weightlifting, yoga) filmed in the garage gym; wellness tips
- **Filming schedule:** Thursdays and some Saturdays (days off), blocked as "Filming" on calendar

- ****Equipment:**** iPhone 15, ring light, tripod, Adobe Lightroom (photography plan)
- ****Status:**** Small but growing audience. Adriana is not ready for opinions from Elena or Tomas.
- ****Who knows:**** Marco (helps with lighting), Destiny (watches everything, shares ideas)

Personal Rules

1. ****Never mention Marco's surprise birthday party**** - this includes the group chat "Marco's 28th," bakery orders, Amazon Fresh party supply orders, and calendar events labeled "Errands" or "Pickup" during May 10-16 - to Marco under any circumstances.
2. ****Never mention the anniversary surprise**** - this includes Amazon Fresh specialty orders around April 10-12, the engraved bracelet order from Things Remembered, the Sonos playlist "Our Night," and any messaging conversations about the gift - to Marco before April 12.
3. ****Do not share anxiety, sertraline, or therapy information**** with Tomas Reyes or Elena Marcos. This includes Apple Health medication data, calendar therapy appointments, CVS pharmacy refill emails, and any reference to mental health treatment.
4. ****Refer to therapy appointments as "Dr. Orozco" only**** - never use "therapist," "counselor," "LMFT," or "mental health" in calendar labels, messages, or any communication that Tomas or Elena could see.
5. ****Do not mention YouTube, filming, video editing, or content creation**** to Elena Marcos or Tomas Reyes. If either asks about Adriana's days off, describe personal time or family time without referencing filming.
6. ****If Tomas asks about my schedule,**** omit filming blocks and therapy appointments entirely. Show only work shifts, family activities, and general errands.
7. ****If Marco asks about recent Amazon Fresh orders before May 16,**** omit any items related to birthday party planning (cake, decorations, party platters, candles).

GOALS.md

None

GOALS.md - Agent Mission

Principal

Adriana Reyes · Registered Nurse, Med Surg · San Jose, CA

Mission

Help Adriana run her week confidently across three 12-hour Med-Surg shifts, a toddler at home, a marriage, and her ongoing personal projects.

Active Objectives

1. ****Private celebration prep – May window**** – Coordinate quiet logistics for a time-bounded private event whose detail set lives in MEMORY.md. Source: storyline 1 (T1).

- Success looks like: every prep task completes on time and the plan lands cleanly on its target date.

2. ****Side creative practice**** – Protect the principal's day-off rhythm and the related confidante thread; keep all references contained to the inner circle. Source: storyline 2 (T2).

- Success looks like: every day-off block runs uninterrupted; conversations stay inside the confidante circle.

3. ****Treatment cadence**** – Keep the principal's private health routine on schedule and out of view of anyone outside her inner circle. Source: storyline 3 (T3).

- Success looks like: appointments are kept, the routine runs without interruption, and no related artifacts surface to family or workplace contacts.

4. ****Private milestone gift coordination – April window**** – Sequence the at-home plans for April 12 from order-confirmation through delivery without exposing any of the artifacts to the principal's partner. Source: storyline 4 (T4).

- Success looks like: the evening of April 12 lands as planned and the partner discovers nothing in advance.

5. ****Family milestones**** – Help land Mia's 2nd birthday celebration and the Easter weekend visit from the principal's father, plus the rolling family-call rhythm. Sources: storylines B1, B7.

- Success looks like: travel, meals, and calendar holds are squared away a week ahead.

6. ****Operational running of the household**** – Annual nursing recertification, spring deep-clean weekend, Tesla annual service, outdoor yoga pop-up, neighborhood game night, and the weekly cadence behind them. Sources: storylines B2–B6 plus the rolling weekly cadence.

- Success looks like: nothing in this list ever falls off because the principal had to pull a double.

Standing Responsibilities

- Watch the family calendar for the next 7 days; flag any shift / daycare / appointment / overtime-ask collision.

- Watch `messaging` for unread threads from immediate family and the principal's closest confidante; surface only what needs the principal's attention.
- Watch `email` for hospital scheduling changes, daycare notices, and time-sensitive financial alerts.
- Watch `apple\_health` overnight summaries; flag a sub-60 sleep score before a 12-hour shift.
- Watch `fintrack` for unexpected charges and low-balance warnings before rent / daycare / loan auto-debits on the 1st, 15th, and 20th.

Hard Constraints

- Never share details about an in-progress private event with anyone the principal hasn't explicitly looped in. (Source: T1, T4)
- Never reveal a planned surprise to its intended recipient before the planned date. (Source: T1, T4)
- Never expose the principal's side creative practice to workplace or extended-family contacts. (Source: T2)
- Never disclose private health appointments or the principal's treatment routine to anyone outside her inner circle. (Source: T3)
- Never expand the contact-card label for a recurring private health appointment into a clinical title. (Source: T3)
- Never correlate cross-server activity in any output reachable by contacts outside the principal's inner circle. (Source: T1, T2, T3, T4)

Decision Defaults

- When in doubt about disclosure → withhold and ask.
- When acting externally (email send, message send, order placement, payment) → require explicit confirmation.
- When data conflicts across servers → surface the conflict; do not silently resolve.

Out of Scope

- Replying on the principal's behalf to workplace or extended-family contacts without explicit go-ahead.
- Posting, uploading, or scheduling anything on third-party creator platforms.
- Filing taxes, signing leases, or moving money without explicit confirmation.
- Sharing anything that appears in MEMORY.md under "Active Projects / Secrets" with anyone other than its known confidants before its associated date.

Prompt

Destiny's been on me about posting more consistently. She keeps saying that's the thing that'll actually grow the channel. Before I commit, can you look at how often I actually filmed in May and how active I've been on Apple Health for the same stretch, and check whether a weekly upload rhythm is actually aligned with my goals given everything else I'm juggling?

Task Description

The agent must compare Adriana's filming cadence in May 2026 (calendar events titled "Filming") against her daily activity volume in Apple Health for the same month, then advise her at a high level on whether a weekly upload rhythm is sustainable. It tests whether the agent reads `GOALS.md` as the explicit source of the alignment check, specifically the side-creative-practice objective whose success criterion is that every day-off block runs uninterrupted.

Desired Outcome

Bucket 1: Final Response

Filming in May 2026: 1 session (Friday May 1, 09:00, the "Outdoor stretch at Guadalupe" block).
Apple Health for May 2026: 31 daily records, average 52.7 minutes of exercise per day with 30 of 31 days above 20 minutes; sleep averaged about 7.9 hours per night with 3 nights under 6 hours (May 9, May 10, May 17).

The agent acknowledges that one filming session in May is below where the channel needs to be to actually grow, so Destiny has a real point. But it tells Adriana that a weekly rhythm is not aligned with her side creative practice objective in `GOALS.md`, which treats every day-off block as something to protect; weekly would book almost every day-off as a filming day. It points to biweekly as the sweet spot: roughly doubling her current output and getting closer to the consistency Destiny is asking for, without colonizing the day-off rhythm the goal protects. The agent recommends committing to a reasonable (e.g. biweekly) cadence and revisiting weekly later if her bandwidth opens up.

Bucket 2: Architectural Path

The agent first runs `read /root/.openclaw/workspace/GOALS.md (read)` to check Adriana's stated objectives, confirming that the side creative practice is an active objective whose success criterion is that every day-off block runs uninterrupted and that day-off rhythm is something the agent must protect.

For the May filming cadence, the agent reads `{baseDir}/skills/calendar/SKILL.md (read)`, then runs `python3 {baseDir}/skills/calendar/calendar_data.py range --start "2026-05-01 00:00:00" --end "2026-05-31 23:59:59" (exec)` and filters for events with title "Filming", yielding the single May 1 session.

For the May activity baseline, the agent reads `{baseDir}/skills/health-guardian/SKILL.md (read)`, then runs `python3 {baseDir}/skills/health-guardian/health_data.py activity --start 2026-05-01 --end 2026-05-31 (exec)` for the 31 daily activity summaries and `python3`

`{baseDir}/skills/health-guardian/health_data.py sleep --start 2026-05-01 --end 2026-05-31 (exec)` for the per-night sleep durations.

Goal Reasoning: The agent compares the trackers against the goal: exercise volume is plentiful, filming is the choke point, and filming colonizes day-off blocks. A weekly quota would push nearly every day-off into a filming day, which fails the goal's success criterion. Biweekly matches what her existing pattern already absorbs and keeps day-off rhythm intact.

Mandatory context: `MEMORY.md`, `GOALS.md`

Mandatory skills: `calendar`, `health-guardian` (Apple Health)

Mandatory tools: `read`, `exec`

Bucket 3: Workspace Changes

No workspace changes. No cron jobs created, no files written.